

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Debate

Meaning of Debate

A debate is a formal discussion or argument on a particular topic in which two opposing sides present their views. One side supports the motion (the proposition), while the other opposes it (the opposition), with the aim of persuading the audience or judges.

Types of Debate

1. Formal Debate – Conducted under strict rules, time limits, and moderation (e.g. school or parliamentary debates).
2. Informal Debate – A casual argument or discussion without strict rules.
3. Parliamentary Debate – Common in legislative houses, following parliamentary procedures

Structure of a Debate

1. Introduction of the Motion – The topic to be debated is presented.
2. Proposition Speakers – Speak in support of the motion.
3. Opposition Speakers – Speak against the motion.
4. Rebuttal – Speakers counter the arguments of the opposing side.
5. Conclusion – Final summary and persuasion.

Features of a Good Debate

Clear and logical arguments

Proper use of language

Evidence and examples to support points

Respect for opposing views

Confidence and clarity of speech

Rules of a Debate

Speakers must speak within the allotted time.

No interruption while a speaker is speaking.

Arguments must be relevant to the topic.

Speakers must address the chairman/moderator

Importance of Debate

Develops critical thinking skills

Improves public speaking and confidence

Encourages research and logical reasoning

Promotes healthy exchange of ideas

Conclusion

Debate is an important form of communication that helps individuals express ideas logically and confidently while respecting differing opinions.